



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Help! My house is falling apart!



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about household problems and money.
- I can talk about solving problems.
- I can talk about things that need to be done.

Ask your partner:

- Would you prefer to spend money on renovations or something else?
Explain.
- When do you get someone to help you with household problems?

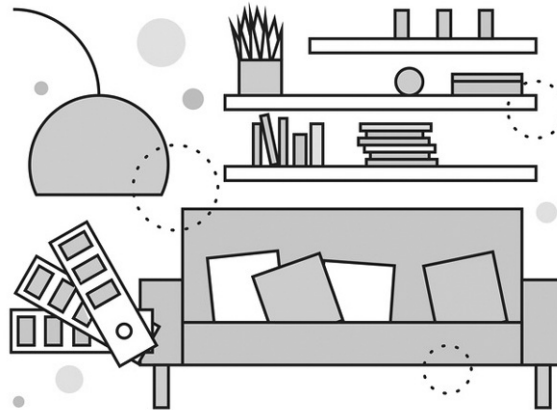




Let's Explore!

Vanessa decides to **renovate***!

* The average person in North America "renovates" their home every 7 years!



INTERIOR DESIGN

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** So did you have someone install your new washer?
- Vanessa:** Yes, and when one thing falls apart, so does another. When I had them install my washer they noticed that my house is insulated with a very outdated and toxic insulation. Needless to say, it's a health and fire hazard. So you'll need the insulation replaced.
- Peter:** So you'll need the insulation replaced.
- Vanessa:** Then, I'll have to have a carpenter put up new drywall. Then I'll get you guys to help me paint the house from top to bottom.
- Sally:** You're welcome to stay with me when all that work is getting done. It'll be dusty if you stay. Your allergies will act up.
- Vanessa:** Thanks. I might take you up on that offer. I've decided to kill two birds with one stone and also have someone renovate the kitchen. The faucets are old and need to be replaced. Basically the whole kitchen needs to be redesigned so I can cook with ease. There are a million other little things that need to be done as well.
- Peter:** That will cost a small fortune.
- Vanessa:** If you don't mind Peter, could I get you to help me and my landlord with a budget?
- Peter:** That's my area of expertise!
- Sally:** This is so awesome! I have a friend who is an interior designer. We could get her to help us design your new kitchen.
- Vanessa:** Well that's a nice offer, but I am pretty set with my own ideas.
- Peter:** Really? You could have fooled me!



Let's Practice!

Something needs to be done again!

Instructions: Underline all the phrases that show something needs to be done or needs doing in the sentences. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. You'll need the insulation replaced.
2. The faucets are old and need to be replaced.
3. Basically the whole kitchen needs to be redesigned so I can cook with ease.
4. There are a million other little things that need to be done as well.



Let's Practice!

What do you do when you own an old house?

Instructions: Complete the sentence by selecting the correct answer. Use: dusty, renovate, outdated, fire hazard, to kill two birds.

1. They noticed that my house is insulated with a very _____ and toxic insulation.
2. Needless to say, it's a health and _____.
3. It'll be _____ if you stay.
4. I've decided _____ with one stone and do both at the same time.
5. I will also have someone _____ the kitchen.





Extension Activity

Describe who you get to fix a problem.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Identify three household problems (broken pipe, leak, etc.).
- Find the names of the people whose job it is to fix the problems.
- Write three causative sentences about the problem.
- Find at least two other problems each person fixes.
- Discuss with a friend which job is the best or worst.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I talk about household problems.

☐ ☐

I identify the people who fix the problems.

☐ ☐

I identify other household problems that each person fixes.

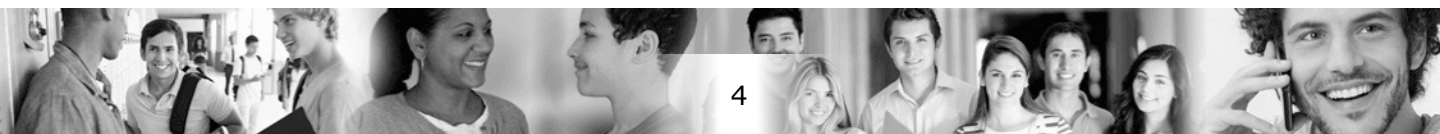
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I discuss which job is the best and worst.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to fall apart** (expression): to break owing to long use or poor construction
e.g. When one thing falls apart, so does another.
- outdated** (adjective): not modern
e.g. They noticed that my house is insulated with a very outdated and toxic insulation.
- fire hazard** (noun): a material, substance, or action that increases the likelihood of an accidental fire occurring
e.g. It's a health and fire hazard.
- allergies** (noun): a reaction of the body typically marked by skin rash
e.g. It'll be dusty and if you stay, your allergies will act up.
- to act up** (expression): when someone or something does not perform as it should
e.g. It'll be dusty and if you stay, your allergies will act up.
- drywall** (noun): material of heavy paper used to make ceilings and walls
e.g. I'll have to have a carpenter put up new drywall.
- faucet** (noun): a device for controlling the flow of liquid from a pipe
e.g. The faucets are old and need to be replaced.
- kill two birds with one stone** (expression): to achieve two aims at once
e.g. I've decided to kill two birds with one stone.
- to renovate** (verb): to restore to good condition
e.g. I've decided to kill two birds with one stone and also have someone renovate the kitchen.
- dusty** (adjective): filled or covered with or as if with dust
e.g. It'll be dusty and if you stay, your allergies will act up.





Learning Points

The Causative with Have and Get

You use the causative with **have** and **get** to show that you want someone to do something for you. You cause the person to do something.

Causative Form with Have

Subject + *have* + agent + base form of the verb + object

I had them install my washer.

Causative Form with Get

Subject + *get* + agent + infinitive + object

I'll get you guys to help me paint the house from top to bottom.

Notice that **have** and **get** can be used in any verb tense or form.

Examples:

- *Did you **have someone install** your new washer?*
- *I'll **have to have a carpenter put up** new drywall.*
- *I'll **get you guys to help me paint** the house from top to bottom.*
- *I've **decided to** kill two birds with one stone and also **have someone renovate** the kitchen.*
- ***Could I get you to help me** with a budget?*





Learning Points

Need + Passive Infinitive and Need + Verb + ing

Need + passive infinitive and **need + verb + ing** are two structures you use to talk about fixing problems. You use these structures to imply that we don't know who will fix the problem, or that the person fixing the problem is not the focus of the sentence.

The focus of the sentence below is the **thing** that needs to be done.

The faucets are old and need to be replaced.

This sentence is a passive sentence because we don't know who will do the action of replacing.

Examples:

- *The faucets are old and **need to be replaced**.*
- *You'll **need to get** someone to replace the insulation.*
- *The whole kitchen **needs to be redesigned** so I can cook with ease.*
- *There are a million other little things that **need to be done** as well.*

